

Here's how smoking affects your baby:

- **The carbon monoxide**, nicotine, and other substances that you inhale pass from your lungs into your bloodstream and cross the placenta.
- **Nicotine** makes your baby's heart beat faster as they struggle for oxygen, which can affect their growth rate.
- **Smoking increases the risk** of miscarriage, premature birth, and low birth weight, and exposure to tobacco chemicals makes your baby more likely to suffer from conditions such as asthma and chest infections after the birth.
- **There is also a higher risk** of crib death (see [Lifestyle changes](#)) if you or your partner smoke. Your partner should stop, too.
- **If you live with a smoker**, you will be inhaling thousands of toxic carcinogenic chemicals that are released into the air around you from the burning end of the cigarette and the exhaled smoke.
- **Several studies** have shown that even passive smoking can be dangerous in pregnancy.